

Journal from the Mouth of the Beaver river up it towards the Green Lake, Bolsover House and Greenwich House at the Red Deers Lake in 1799 by Peter Fidler

**1799 August 24<sup>th</sup> Saturday** ~ at 2 ¼ PM entered Beaver river & went up it EbS ¼ . a high dry steep bare bank on N Side - at the entrance into the river & easy current - ENE ½ - SEbE 1¼ - ESE 1½ a small Poplar Isd on the North side the river river ¼ mile wide here is a branch on the N side - SSE ¾ - E ¼ a bare knowl on N side - SE 1¼ - SSE ½ burnt woods on the NW side - E ¼ - SE ¾ - two Small bays here one on each side, keep the middle way - near SbE 1 wide and grassy. keep the South side channel - SEbS ¾ - an opening. keep the Middle - woods edge ¾ mile apart - grassy in the middle with a serpentine Course - SSE 1½ a Poplar Island on the W side - SSE 2 a branch & kind of Lake on the N side put up at 6 ¼ PM - easy current all Day - with low grassy banks - & willows Light Airs at S Clear & Hot. - The 5th Inst. left Cumberland House with 3 Canoes to settle in the Beaver river at the Green Lake - 3 Men p Canoe - & one Canoe 4 men - Mr Isham Steered one Canoe - and the White Boy - his wife & Son - accompanied us as a Pilot from Cumberland House - but they knew not the least of the Track from that Place to the Isle a la Crosse which is by much the most difficult of the whole way - we proceeded on by the assistance of my Old Journal & Maps made when I went from the Athapescow in 1792 - The 20th Inst overtook Mess Auld. Linkletter. & Flett. from Churchill with 3 Boats - in Primes Lake - as they are going to build at Green Lake I intend to proceed about 30 miles farther to the Beaver Ground Lake - as our Pilots say that it is much the best place for a House - for Furrs & Provisions - Mr Linkletter builds at Isle a la Crosse - he has 6 Men - he also built a small place at the Buffalo Lake - & Mr Auld a small one at the Water Hen Lake besides his house at the Green Lake Lat 55°.27'.15" N & Longitude 107°.40' Wt - the Mouth of the Beaver river at the entrance of the Isle a la Crosse Lake - Put up in Company with Mr Auld with 2 Boats - we remained for him on the road for his accompanying us as he had no pilot for the Beaver river.

**August 25<sup>th</sup> Sunday** While we waited for Mr Auld at the mouth of Beaver river Mr McTavish of Old Company used every mean & rogish method in his power to persuade our pilot to leave us - as he is so very much dissatisfied at our attempting to build in this River - at 4  $\frac{1}{3}$  AM we proceeded up Beaver river as yesterday & went, near ESE 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  a willow Island in the Middle of the river - SWbS 2 went along a narrow part SW  $\frac{1}{4}$  runs from the Middle of the river to the South Side - SEbS 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - A pretty bare knowl on the W side, with a few firs - a pretty high hill appears up the reach from SE to SbE a good way off. perhaps 30 or 40 Miles - SEbS 2 a small river on the East side called the Wading River (come in all since we set of this morning 9 Miles) - SSW 1 & 1 a few firs on the W side - low grassy, willowy sides all along the river & the woods about 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles apart - river about 60 Yards wide - SSE  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  two small swampy lakes one on each side of the River - S  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SEbE  $\frac{1}{2}$  another small Lake on W side - NE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - EbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  a branch on the E side & small pines - SSE  $\frac{2}{3}$  - barren ground on the E side - the water has fallen in this river 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  feet within this Month past - SSW 1 - SW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSW  $\frac{2}{3}$  - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSW  $\frac{2}{3}$  - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  a small Isd on the W side - SSE  $\frac{1}{4}$  the head of the willow Isd

*willow Isd. what Old go. 37. 30  
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SEbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  rather stony bank on the East side - EbS  $\frac{1}{3}$  a steep bare bank on the E side - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SWbS  $\frac{1}{2}$  - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SEbE  $\frac{1}{3}$  high bare bank on the East side - SbW  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SEbS  $\frac{2}{3}$  - S  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SW  $\frac{3}{4}$  a small Creek & Portage out of this river into a small Lake on the West side - SWbS 1 a small Creek on the W side - steepish banks, & good woods on both sides of the river all below, quite low, dirty banks - & willows - SE  $\frac{3}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{4}$  Perch River on the East side 12 Yards wide, easy current & steep banks a Portage on N side into another small river & Lake - WSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - WNW  $\frac{1}{4}$  pretty open high land on the N side & a few stragling firs & 2 steep bare sand banks, on the W side (S  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - E  $\frac{1}{4}$  bare sand banks on the E side - SE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - W  $\frac{1}{8}$  - NW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - NNW  $\frac{1}{8}$ ) high steep bare sand banks on the W side & a portage over the Point including the last 9 Courses SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - a small creek on Wt side - SEbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SbE  $\frac{1}{2}$  - EbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SEbS  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SEbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SWbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - WNW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - a small creek on Wt side - SbW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{4}$  & put up at 6  $\frac{1}{2}$  PM - Light Airs at North - clear & hot - Shaded a little in the Morning ~

**August 26 Monday** ~ at 4 ¼ am got underway - went SWbW ⅓ - SSW ¼ - SSE ¼ - SSW ⅓ - SEbE ⅓ - SSE ¼ - a small stony Island and a shoal ripple above it here begin the rapids - & strong current - all below pretty easy current - EbS ⅓ - SEbS ¼ a shoal ripple - E ¼ - SSW ¼ shoal & strong - SEbE ½ - WSW ¼ - E ½ a fine flatt, grassy point on the W side - SSW ¼ led - SE ½ - SSE ⅓ - SbW ⅓ these 4 last courses a continued, shoal strong rapid - when the water is low, they carry all along shore - EbS ¼ - S ¼ - SSW ¼ - SEbE ¼ - SbE ¼ - ESE ¾ - SbW ½

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SSE ⅓ - SSW ⅓ shoal & strong rapids - all these last Courses a rapid at every point - S ¼ - SE ⅓ - SSE ¼ - ESE ¼ - SEbS ⅓ - SEbE 1 - hitherto the banks of the river has been pretty high since the beginning of the rapids with Good Pines &c - the banks now appears much lower - & indicates an end of these rapids being nearly all passed - E ¼ - NE ¼ - SEbS 1 - ENE ½ - SbE 1 Easy current these 4 last reaches - ESE ⅓ - SSE ⅓ - SEbE ⅔ a small creek on the East side - SbW 1 ½ another small Creek on E<sup>t</sup> side - Boil River on the West side - about 10 Yards wide, pretty deep & good current, a fine open grassy dry place at the mouth of it where it falls into the Beaver river where we put up at 5 PM - our provisions is now reduced to only 2 or 3 Days - & not knowing when or where we shall be supplied - The Boil river has a small Isd at its mouth & falls out of a Lake of the Same name a few miles up it. there is a communication by water for small Canoes to the Cold Lake high up the Beaver river - This river runs Westerly - Light breezes at South with a shower of rain at 1 PM - at 5 am we left Mr Auld amongst the rapids I have not seen him since - they will be some time in getting their Boats over the rapids - as they are much more unhandy to manage than Canoes.

**27<sup>th</sup> Tuesday** ~ at 6 ½ am got underway & Hugh Sabbeston accidentally broke his Canoe just after we got off which detained us 1 hour to repair it again - Went SbW ¼ - E ¼ - SSE ⅓ shoal ridge of stones across the river S ½ - ESE ½ - a proper dam of stones entirely across the river - cleared a narrow passage thro it & hauled the Canoes thro it - SEbS ½ a small Creek on the E side - S ⅓ - SE ¼ - SSE ¼ - ESE ¼ - S ¼ - SEbS ¼ - SSE ⅓ - SE ⅓ - S ¼ - SW ½ - two small creeks on the E side - WSW ⅓ a high bank on the west side & woody - S ⅓ - ESE ⅓ - I necessitated to put up for rain at 9 ¼ am - at 3 ½ PM the rain abated & we again proceeded &

**August 27<sup>th</sup>** went SSE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - E  $\frac{1}{4}$  a high barrish grassy bank on the E<sup>t</sup> side - S  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{3}$  a shoal, bad stony place - SEbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  & again obliged to put up for rain at 5 PM - It rained pretty hard all the while before we put up this last time; the other 2 Canoes went a little ahead as the bank is steep where we encamped - Left a few lines for Mr Auld at the Mouth of the Boil river for Mr Auld acquainting him that our Provisions being nearly every bit expended & that we could not wait him on that account - also told him that at any river but particularly at the Mouth of the Green Lake river - that we should leave him a few more lines for his guidance to that Lake - A Canadian Canoe with 2 Men passed us on their way to the Green Lake, we suppose to tell the Master there on our unexpected arrival & to get all the Indians out of the way if possible - A variety of showry Cloudy, Rainy weather - wind variable Southerly - & in the afternoon Northerly -

**28<sup>th</sup> Wednesday** At 5  $\frac{1}{2}$  AM got underway went SbW  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  a small Creek on the E<sup>t</sup> side - WbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  - a high bare grassy bank on the W<sup>t</sup> side - & these last courses all a strong rapid - SW  $\frac{2}{3}$  - a small creek on the W<sup>t</sup> side & burnt woods - SSW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - S 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  a small Creek on the W side - SSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SEbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  a pretty middling sized creek on the W side EbN  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{2}$  - NNE  $\frac{1}{16}$  - ESE  $\frac{1}{16}$  - S  $\frac{1}{16}$  - ESE  $\frac{1}{3}$  - E  $\frac{1}{8}$  - ESE  $\frac{1}{8}$  Perch hunting river on E<sup>t</sup> side, small - a communication this way up this river - & carry over a pretty long Carrying Place or two & fall into the Setting river - that joins the Saskatchewan river below the Neck of Land - below Hudsons House - Left this river at 9  $\frac{1}{2}$  Went SSW  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SbE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SEbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{3}$  - ESE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{16}$  - E  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - EbN  $\frac{1}{4}$  - ESE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SWbS  $\frac{1}{8}$  - EbN  $\frac{1}{8}$  - rather steep sandy bank on the E<sup>t</sup> side - ever since the end of the rapids a little before the S 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  course easy current & low banks - dirty - & smaller woods than below - SSE  $\frac{1}{8}$  Duck Portage on the E<sup>t</sup> side & a small Creek - WSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - a sandy bank on the W<sup>t</sup> side & a few small poplars - SE  $\frac{1}{16}$  - NNE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - Pines appear ahead - half way to the Green Lake - SW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - E  $\frac{1}{3}$  - WSW  $\frac{1}{16}$  - W  $\frac{1}{6}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{16}$  - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  a few firs on the W<sup>t</sup> side - ESE  $\frac{1}{8}$  a low barren knowl on the E<sup>t</sup> side - ENE  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - WNW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - ESE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - NNE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - NNW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - two small branches on the E<sup>t</sup> side - E  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - WNW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{8}$  -

**August 28<sup>th</sup>** E  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - ESE  $\frac{1}{4}$  a branch of the Green Lake river on the E<sup>t</sup> side - SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - E  $\frac{1}{8}$  - S  $\frac{1}{16}$  the Main branch of the Green Lake river entered it at  $\frac{1}{2}$  past 12 went up it about  $\frac{3}{4}$  of an hour & came to a fine high dry barren ground, at 1  $\frac{1}{4}$  PM & put up - found a few Indians here - a sandy bank here, with woods on the E<sup>t</sup> side - Gave the Inds 4 Qt of High Spirits & other useful presents - Traded from them a little fresh meat & which came very apropos - also Traded a small Canoe from them for our Pilot to go in - The Green Lake is about 5 Miles from the Mouth of the river where it joins the Beaver river - a true SSE course gives for the Lat 54°..14'..45" & Long<sup>d</sup> 107°..36' W<sup>t</sup> - for the Green Lake House - The Lake is Long & narrow - & full of a Green floating grass - from whence the Lake derives its name - the best & firmest Tickamy in this Lake as is known in any part of this extensive country & very plentiful - The Canadian Master came to us to endeavour to drive away the Inds that we luckily found here but without effect. There has been a House here ever since or before the Smallpox in 1781 - The river betwixt the Green Lake & Beaver river - very crooked, short turning - easy current & pretty deep - with a low meadow bottom on each side quite clear of woods for  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile - covered with a thick strong, coarse grass - The Canadians keep a few horses here they have brought over Land in the Winter from the Saskatchewan River - but as the Country hereabout is wet & swampy & thicketty - they are of little use - to the Southward - the Country is more dry & open - At Isle a la Crosse they have also a few Horses there introduced since 1793 - but there they are of still less use except for dragging firewood in the Winter. There is but about 30 Men able to kill furs at this river - all Southern Indians - they seldom visit their Countrymen at the Saskatchewan river

**29<sup>th</sup> Thursday** Very heavy rain all last Night & the Indians being Drunk & troublesome - we could scarcely keep ourselves dry in our Tents - Traded from them 2 rds 1 Swan - besides what is mentioned before - at 5  $\frac{1}{2}$  AM got away & proceeded back & entered Beaver river again & went up it W  $\frac{1}{8}$  - near WSW 1 a ripple - WSW 1, Steepest bank on the N side & a creek on the S side - WSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - NWbW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - NW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - W  $\frac{1}{2}$  - NNW  $\frac{3}{4}$  - W  $\frac{3}{4}$  a Creek on S side WSW  $\frac{3}{4}$  - NNW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - a fine sandy bank on N side - SbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  a strong, steep rapid, led up it - SSW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - WSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  shoal - SW  $\frac{1}{3}$  - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSE  $\frac{3}{4}$  a small grass Island.

**August 29<sup>th</sup>** WSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  a fine level sand bank on the S side & no woods near the river there - NWbW  $\frac{1}{4}$  a ripple - SWbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  a creek on the N side - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  - WSW  $\frac{1}{4}$

*Lat. 54° 13' 30" Long. 119° 27'*

NNW  $\frac{1}{4}$  a low flatt willow point on the S side, and a small grass Island on the Same side WbN  $\frac{1}{3}$  Rapid - WbS  $\frac{1}{3}$  - WNW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{2}$  a willow Isd in the middle of the river & a strong rapid - WbN  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SSW  $1\frac{1}{2}$  a large broken pine Tree on the upper end of this reach on the S side, called the Devils Head - WNW  $\frac{1}{3}$  WSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  a small Lake on the South side - S 1 a willow Island and a shoal bad rapid - S  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - W  $\frac{1}{4}$  - a kind of open land little woods near the river - NW  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{2}$  & arrived at the entrance of the Barren Ground Lake river at 4  $\frac{1}{2}$  PM & put up - The woods here about 1 mile or more apart & small willows & grassy Plains on both sides the river Since we passed from Green Lake river - The Beaver river is more wide than below with sand - from 50 to 100 Yds wide - easy current betwixt the rapids in general - Set a net at the Mouth of the Barren Ground River & angled there a few small Jack - Mr Campbell the Canadian Master & 1 Man accompanied us in a small Canoe, they are endeavouring to get our Pilots from us & those few Indians that accompanied us from the Green Lake - a very thick fogg in the Morning at noon cleared up afterwards pretty hot -

**30<sup>th</sup> Friday** Fresh breezes at NE cloudy weather with drizzling rain Took up our net had very little Success - at 5  $\frac{1}{4}$  AM got underway Left the Beaver river & went up the Barren Ground Lake river as ant from N to EbS 2 miles making SW  $\frac{3}{4}$  & came to the woods edge - shoal here - SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  a branch on the S side - WbN  $\frac{1}{2}$  a branch on the N side - E  $\frac{1}{4}$  - from N to S on the left, to N on the right hand 5 miles making SWbS 2 miles - W  $\frac{1}{4}$  the woods on the left all on the right a low grassy open Country & no woods - great numbers of Nettles growing all thro this low flatt level - Went W  $\frac{3}{4}$  & a hill & woods on the right hand - near NW  $\frac{1}{2}$  along the Woods - near W  $\frac{1}{4}$  an Island of Grass & left the woods that was before on our left hand, & kept to the N of them thro a low wet swampy Country - Went 7 miles making SSW  $2\frac{1}{2}$  very crooked short turnings & fine high steep bank on the left hand side - these last courses from N on the left to N on the right being 4 Points more than a Circle - The river or rather creek runs is very crooked - Nearly as the last 7 miles -

**August 30<sup>th</sup>** 3 miles making SbW 1 - river contracts & woods on both sides - & shoal & stony - below a soft muddy bottom with Poplar where any woods grew put up at 3 ½ PM - as we find the river too shoal to be able to proceed up it with the full lading in the Canoes - Sent Mr Dunnett & one Indn Man in search of some Indians that are supposed to be not far of as we found some of their Canoes here - Got 9 Ducks from Indians.

**31<sup>st</sup> Saturday** Fresh breezes at NW. flying Clouds

*ingland - De Nat. O's 22 87.59.30*  
*Lat. 54.13.14 - - 87.59.30*

Sent Joseph Lewis & our Indian Pilot to see the Lake & examine the river - & to know what length & appearance it has - as here & near here it is entirely choaked up with shoals - & little water - at Night they returned having been at the Lake & they say that it is nearly one continued shoal rapid all the way which they suppose to be about 10 Miles - they brought 19 Ducks, & Mr Isham killed 12 near the Tent - Mr Dunnett & the Indian man returned that went in search of Inds Yesterday - they have seen 4 Men, but they had got no provisions - but are going to hunt for us.

**Sept<sup>mr</sup> 1<sup>st</sup> Sunday** ~ Early this Morning our Men put half Cargo into the Canoes & proceeded up the river - they will have a number of passages to make at the rapids to make way to float the Canoes thro. Myself & Geo Flett remain here to take care of the remainder of the Goods - we have now nothing to eat except the few Ducks the Indians kill us. 2 Indian Canoes with only One Man passed us on his way up to the Lake gave him ammunition to hunt Ducks &c with for us - also all the other Indians I gave the same to for the like purposes - also gave the Pilot 3 Qt keg of liquor to hunt well & induce the others to do the same ~ The Canadian Master with 1 man proceeded up the river 2 hours after our people went away & one man remains here to watch our motions - Light Airs at N fine hot weather.

**2<sup>nd</sup> Monday** Wind & weather as Yesterday

*Day De Nat. O's 22 86.32.30*  
*Lat. 54.12.58 - - 86.32.30*

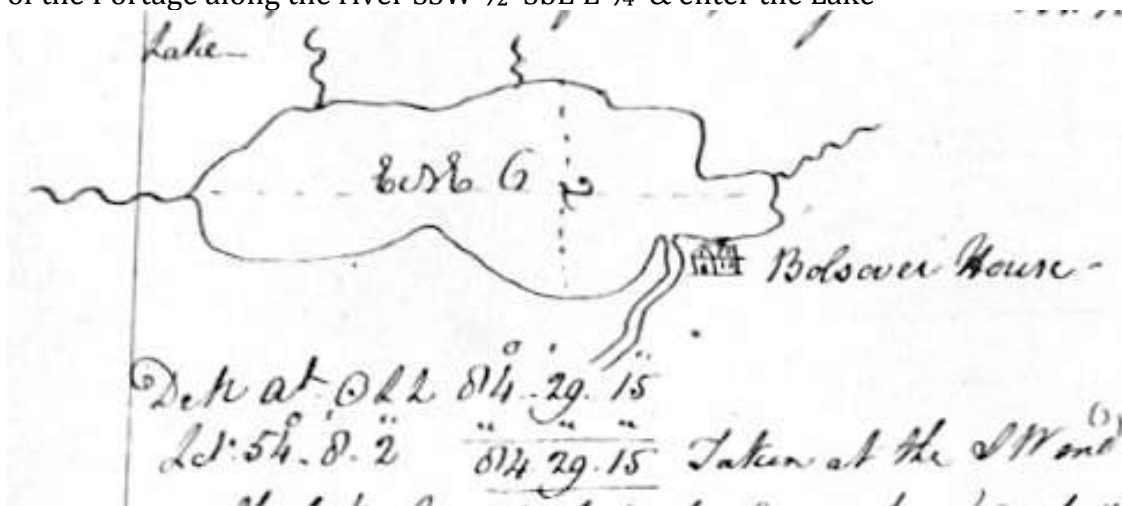
**3<sup>rd</sup> Tuesday** at 8 am Hugh Gibson with an Indian man arrived here with 3 horses - & brought Letters from Mr Bird at Buckingham House which place they left on Saturday last at 10 am - at 9 am the

**September 3<sup>rd</sup>** of ours returned down from the upper end of the river, having put out the goods at the lower end of a very shoal long rapid, & left 1 Man from each canoe to carry the Goods to where the water is deeper & then to embark it again - they have had much trouble in clearing away the stones for a passage for the Canoes - at 10  $\frac{3}{4}$  am we embarked all the rest of the things & went away & arrived at the Portage at 6  $\frac{1}{6}$  PM. The distance by the river is about 12 Miles, so very crooked with short turnings - in some places betwixt the rapids still deep water - The True Course is about SbW 6 Miles. fine dry barren ground on both sides of the river - particularly on the N side - only here & there a few small stragling Poplars - The Men had carried all the Goods about  $\frac{3}{4}$  of a mile to deep water along a fine grassy plain on the North side Indians on Hunting but no success - Fresh breezes at NW with flying showers of Thunder & rain - The Canadian Man that watched us at the foot of the rapids went to the Green Lake in a small Canoe ~

**4<sup>th</sup> Wednesday** Fresh Gales at NW, with Thunder & hail carried all over the Portage & put up - Mr Isham & myself, went in a Canoe to examine about the head of the river for a convenient Place to build at but found none - Got 9 Geese & 1 Swan from our Pilot - 20 Ducks & 3 Swans from the Hunters & 1 Goose from another Indian - Gave the Indians a small treat of Liquor these 2 Nights past as encouragement for them to exert themselves for us in Hunting - also gave the Men a Pint of Brandy each - on account of the severe duty they have under gone of late

**5<sup>th</sup> Thursday** Mr Isham myself with 4 Men in a large Canoe went nearly all round the Lake but could not find a convenient place for both wood & water - went to the very bottom of the Lake and close along the N side - at 10  $\frac{1}{2}$  AM we returned & embarked the Goods in the Canoes & went up the river about  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile & carried every thing 1120 Yards across a fine plain on the North side the head of the river to a few Pines where we shall Build as it is the best place we have as yet seen. The worst inconvenience is the push distance to fetch water - In the evening an Indian man with 3 young lads & 2 women arrived & brot the dry meat of 1 Buffalo - 1

**Sept 5<sup>th</sup>** parchment Skin & 1 small beaver skin, which they traded for Liquor Course from the West end of the Portage along the river SSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  SbE E  $\frac{1}{4}$  & enter the Lake



Taken at the SW end of the Portage River near the Lake from 50 to 110 Yards rushes & grass all thro the upper end of the Lake - on the N side a sandy shore with several fine grass plains our Pilot started a fine Herd of Buffalo there but unfortunately killed not one - We used Trading Axes as there is no falling Axes here - put down two nets in the Lake as our Pilots say that the Fish are very plentiful Fresh Gales at NW cloudy cold weather ~

**6<sup>th</sup> Friday** In the Morning the Thermometer stood at 20 which is very cold at this season of the Year in these parts. a thick fogg - afternoon clear & warm Fresh breezes at SW Overhauled our nets but caught not a single fish which appears that what the Pilot said is not true of their being plenty of Fish in this Lake

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Course from where the Observation was taken Yesterday to Bolsover House where this is taken is SSW p Compass distance 1 mile to the Place Cleared the Foundation of a Small Store 12 feet Square & got it 5 logs high - Rigged & paid off our Pilot Indians being drinking -

**7<sup>th</sup> Saturday** Sent John Johnston & Balice to attend the nets - the rest of the men got the Walls of the small store up - In the Afternoon gave the Indians a little credit & ammunition to hunt meat for the House & they all went away to be back with meat in a few days as the Buffalo is pretty plentiful about 15 miles off about the Loon Lake - divided all the meat remaining amongst 13 of us which is only 3 lb p Man - In the evening put some necessary things by I wrote Letters - Myself & 3 Men are to proceed up Beaver river to the Red Deers Lake to winter with the Bungees & Towau [Chippewa & Ottawa] - as 3 Canoes are sent there - Mr Pruden is to come to take charge of this Place from Buckingham House - & Hugh Sabeston acts until he arrives here Fresh breezes at NW. Clear & hot

**September 8<sup>th</sup> Sunday** Yesterday Mr Campbell & the other man returned to the Green Lake to acquaint Mr Duncan McTavish of our building here - the country all about Bolsover House is in general fine dry land - a good place for the Buffalo in the Winter season - at 7 AM sent of those that came here from Buckingham House & Mr Isham accompanied them back to that place; also at the same time myself, Mr Flett, Jos Lewis & Jno Ballenden set off for the Red Deers Lake - got all over the Portage at 9 ½ & put up 3 Miles above where we lay by with part of the Goods the 1st Inst ~ One Canoe of us we have no other provisions than what came to each mans share Yesterday which was Only 3 lb p Man - so that we shall have intirely to depend upon what we may kill - during our Passage to the Red Deers Lake which will take us by the Indian account 18 Days - we have unluckely no Indian to Pilot us there & none of us have ever been at that Place before - I offered large presents to an Indian to accompany us in the capacity as Pilot, but not one would listen to our earnest entreaties - they are very much afraid of the Bungee Indians who at present live near that Lake put up at 6 PM - Water rose in this bad shoal river about 2 Inches since we went up it - Killed 2 Geese & 1 Partridge Fresh breezes at SW Clear hot weather ~

**9<sup>th</sup> Monday** Wind & weather as Yesterday - at 5 ½ am got underway & went down the same way we came up & arrived at Beaver river at 5 ¼ PM & put up - plenty of Fish jumping at the mouth of the Barren Ground river - we angled but caught nothing - Shot 1 large & 8 Small Ducks - also 2 Geese which fell in the woods, & unfortunately could not find them.

**10<sup>th</sup> Tuesday** Fresh Gales at NW thick cloudy weather, at 5 am got underway, went up Beaver river ENE ½ the woods edge on the N side NW ⅛ - W ½ - SW ¼ - WSW ⅓ - NE ⅛ a creek on the N side - SW ¼ - WbN ¼ - SbE ⅛ - SbW ¼ - NWbW ⅛ - SSE ¼ - SWbW ¼ - W ¼ - SbE ⅙ - WbS ⅙ - high dry sand bank on the N side with a few Stones - all below low muddy banks - NW 1/16 - SWbS ⅙ - WbN ¼ - SSE 1/10 - EbN ⅛ - SW 1/16 a fine sandy point on the South side WNW ¼ - SE ¼ WSW ⅙ - NE 1/16 - nearly all round the compass 2 ½ Miles making WbS ½ - W ¼ - a Sandy Mountain on the N side - D° 3 miles - making WSW ¾ - a pretty good creek on the NS - D° 13 miles

**Sept 10<sup>th</sup>** making WSW 5 miles & put up on the N side at a fine steep high sandy bank & small firs at 5 ½ PM - a little below a kind of an Island on the N side - This latter part of the Day course from E to N on right to N on the left hand, being 6 points of the Compass more than a compleat circle - so very crooked - very short turnings, low dirty banks and all willows - no good place to put up at scarcely - not a single pine tree to be seen - woods edge about ¼ mile apart - & betwixt all high willows & the river running in a very serpentine manner - making little progress in a direct line - current not strong - & rather a sandy bottom - Killed 6 Large & 4 Small Ducks - Cold weather in the evening - we find that Mr Angus Shaw of the Old Company have gone up this way 3 Days before us with 5 Loaded Canoes to Winter at the Red Deers Lake - where we are going to.

**11<sup>th</sup> Wednesday** ~ a little rain in the Night - flying Clouds & fresh Gales at NW at 5 ¾ AM got underway, went as Yesterday all round the Compass 10 Miles making WSW 5 - one mile above where we slept last Night a fine sandy bank on the N side - 2 Miles below this another fine sandy bank on the N side - & 1 mile above the last a steep dry gravelly bank on the S side - near SWbS ¾ a small creek on S side - & river rather wider, good poling the Canoe along - fine sandy bottom - below the river was not more than 15 Yards wide - Stoney on the S side & firs - NW ⅛ - NE ⅛ - NW ¼ - SW ¼ - WSW ½ a small ripple - high bank & a number of Muscle shells on the S. side ~

*Lat. 54° 19' 4" N Long. 79° 35' 30" W*

The Sun rather fallen before I began to observe - therefore this Observation is not to be depended upon - ENE ¼ - WNW ⅓ - NNW ⅛ - SW ¼ a small ripple & gravel on the S side - N ⅛ - S ¼ - near SSW ¼ a small willow Isd in the middle of the river & a strongish ripple - WSW ⅓ near WNW ½ a high bank, a big Stone & a good sized Creek on the N side - SE ¼ - SSE ½ from ENE to N 3 miles making SWbS 1 ½ a sandy bank on the S side - at the upper end of which vast numbers of Muscles in the edge of the water - we collected about One Bushel to eat at Night for want of a sufficient quantity of other eatables - 2 Sets of Old Tent poles at the lower end of the high bank on S side - NW ¼ - from N to ENE 4 making SSW 3 miles & put up at 6 PM - on N side - Good pines & firs in several places on the S side we seldom came to the main bank of the river on the N side - Killed 4 Large & 4 Small Ducks - also shot a Swan - which fell & could not find it - 2 small Lakes on N side upon this Point - & Open Land only small willows &c

**September 12<sup>th</sup> Thursday** Last Night boiled a kettle of those muscles we got yesterday but after eating 5 or 6 each we was all taken with a sickness at the stomach - & vomiting which made us desist from eating any more of them Light breezes at SW Clear & hot - a thick fogg in the Morning ~ at 5  $\frac{1}{3}$  am got underway - went from E to N 4 making SSW 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - The Loon River falls in here on the S side, from 12 to 15 Yards wide, apparently - pretty good water - a high steep bluff bank at the Point betwixt the two rivers - high bank on the S side & pretty good pines - we found no pines Yesterday until near evening - all firrs - Woods about  $\frac{1}{3}$  mile apart This river falls out of the Loon Lake about 15 Miles off - fine open land around it by the Indian report - NWbN  $\frac{1}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  - NWbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SWbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  - NWbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - N  $\frac{1}{8}$  stoney point on the N side - WSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - NWbN  $\frac{1}{4}$  a shoal strong ripple - ENE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - WbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  shoal & stoney - NbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  a high bare sand bank on the N side - WbN  $\frac{1}{8}$  - a small Creek on the N side EbN  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SSE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - NNW  $\frac{1}{4}$  crooked short turnings as above 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  making WbS 1 mile - plenty of Buffalo tracks along shore, the first we have yet seen in this river - Very crooked from NE to E 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  making WbS 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  Miles - SSW  $\frac{1}{8}$  -

*11 $\frac{1}{2}$  - 54.16.20*  
*70.55.0*

A hammock of Pines appears ahead  $\frac{3}{4}$  of a mile off - & Tent poles on the North side - WSW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - N to S 3  $\frac{1}{2}$  making WbS 2 miles - N  $\frac{1}{8}$  a particular fine bluff headed Pine appears on the North side near the river - 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  as before making WbS 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  an Island on the N side - D $^{\circ}$  1  $\frac{1}{2}$  mak<sup>g</sup> WbS 1 mile a high bluff of Poplars on the South side - These 2 last Courses 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile each making West 2 miles straight - NNE to SW 7 making WSW 5 - put up on the N side at 5  $\frac{1}{4}$  PM - Woods  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile apart & good sandy bottom - fine poleing - I walked about 6 miles along the North side - & Killed 3 Ducks - a sandy soil - & all firrs - Got 1 Swan - 7 Geese & 2 large & 3 small Ducks - a number of Geese &c in the river but they are very wild & scarce any getting near them upon almost every point they sit in small flocks - This is the best Day hunt that we have yet made - The Swan is the one I shot last Night & could not find ~ we found it at the edge of the river about 1 mile above where we slept last Night - river banks in general all small willows & very crooked the course of the river - numbers of small Lakes on the projecting points in the river, & swampy.

**Sept 13<sup>th</sup> Friday ~ Last Night**

*1 night De Nat. a. a. 88. 9. 15*  
*Lat. 54. 17. 6*      88. 9. 15

Taken where we put up - The willows are so very high & the river so narrow that it is almost impossible to ascertain the true course of the river Strong Gales Westerly, Clear weather - at 5  $\frac{3}{4}$  am got underway went WNW  $\frac{1}{2}$  (along a Willow Isd the lower end of which we slept opposite to) - a Creek on N S & the edge of the Woods - SWbS  $\frac{1}{2}$  - near S 1 - SSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - NW  $\frac{1}{2}$  a number of Buffalo Tracks here - a noted place apparently for those Animals crossing over the river here - NEbE  $\frac{1}{3}$  - SbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SWbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SWbS  $\frac{1}{2}$  - WNW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - WbN  $\frac{1}{2}$  river 60 Yards wide here - & fine sandy bottom we pole the Canoe along more than  $\frac{7}{8}$  of the Day - river below from 20 to 30 Yards wide - SSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SbW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - WSW  $\frac{3}{4}$  a small Willow Island - SE  $\frac{1}{16}$  - W  $\frac{1}{4}$  - WbN  $\frac{1}{4}$  - S  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - NW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - SW 1 - SE  $\frac{1}{8}$  - W  $\frac{1}{8}$  - SSW  $\frac{1}{8}$  - a fine high bare grassy Knowl on the North side & a single lopped Pine Tree - & a good large Creek on the same side a little above -

*me De Nat. 88. 7. 15*  
*Lat. 54. 16. 14*      88. 7. 15

Three short reaches one mile making SSW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - 8 miles making NW 5 - 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making SW 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - Much burnt woods on the South side and a number of Buffalo Tracks - SW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - WSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  - Good Pines on the South side & plenty of Buffalo Tracks NNW  $\frac{1}{6}$  - WSW  $\frac{1}{4}$  a Creek on the South side NbE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - many more Tracks here - 4 miles making NWbW 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  - and put up at 5  $\frac{1}{2}$  PM on the N side - High & pretty steep hills on the North side here at least 200 feet above the level of the river - Killed 3 Swans - 1 Goose & 1 Duck - Poled all Day.

*Day De Nat. a. a. 88. 14. 30*  
*Lat. 54. 14. 28*      88. 14. 30

**14<sup>th</sup> Saturday** ~ Light breezes at SW Clear fine weather Poled all Day Good hunting sands this Day - Killed 8 Geese - at 6 am got underway The Thermometer at 24 - went 2 miles making NWbW 1 a stony point & small Creek on the North side - 3  $\frac{1}{2}$  making SWbW 2. bareish high hills on the South side - 2 miles making S 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - SSW  $\frac{3}{4}$  a small Creek on the South side - 2 miles making NW 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - ENE  $\frac{1}{8}$

*88. 77. 25. 0*  
77. 25. 0      *Lat. 54. 15. 17*

N  $\frac{1}{8}$  Good pines, steepish bank & stoney bay on the North side - 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making N 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - a good creek on the North Side & bare high Knowls - NW 1 - 4 miles making WbS 3 open ground on the South side, high Knowls & a stoney ripple - 3 miles making WbN 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - a deep fine Gully & Creek

**Sept 14<sup>th</sup>** on the South side - no wood on the South side of the Mouth of the Creek 2 miles making WbN 1. fine low banks on the North side - 2 ½ miles making NW 1 ½ & put up on the South side at 6 ¼ PM - passed a number of Buffalo Tracks this Day - & the country appears good for that Animal - several of their tracks are quite fresh - but the 5 Canoes of Canadians going up this way so very lately & by their universal custom of singing frighten all animals away within hearing of them - The 2<sup>nd</sup> Day after we came down the barren ground river we found a Moose under the steep bank in this river - & we approached it very nigh but unluckely our Guns was wet & would not give fire - by which means it got away before we had time to put them in order - which was unfortunate as we had then very little to eat.

**15<sup>th</sup> Sunday** ~ at 5 am got underway went 5 miles making WSW 3 ½ - & stopped for rain at 8 ¼ am - Killed 5 Geese - fine bare, grassy hills on the North side & a high lopped pine Tree - at 11 ½ am we again got away & went 5 miles making SWbW 4 - river more straighter than usual & the woods not more than ¼ mile apart - the intervening space is the river & willows - The present bed of the river appears to have been recently here - & that the Points are slowly & gradually accumulating - & the bays are constantly decreasing by the continual friction of the waters - This appears very plainly to be the case - as several different sized willows in ridges all increasing in age from the points within I have counted 18 of these successively & alternated accumulations beyond which the ground & marks are quite obliterated & not any distinct ridges to be seen - This is the case in several other rivers - that run a serpentine course - betwixt high banks - & when the intervening space is a valley - 3 miles making SSW 2 - SWbS 1 Good Pines all along the South side these last 4 miles & little on the North side - 3 miles making WSW 2 - a short crooked reach near the middle of the last course which runs N - & a large Creek on the South side, much water in it & several pretty strong rapids in it N ⅛ - W ¼ & put up on the North side at 5 ½ PM - & Killed 1 more Goose - Afternoon cloudy & flying Showers of rain - and fresh Gales at WNW.

**Septem<sup>br</sup> 16<sup>th</sup> Monday** Fresh Gales at WNW with rain, hail & Snow all Day - did not proceed owing to the very bad Weather ~ Killed 1 Goose ~

**17<sup>th</sup> Tuesday** ~ Fresh Gales at W flying Clouds & Cold - at 5  $\frac{3}{4}$  am got underway - went 3 miles making WSW 2 Met a Canadian man his wife & 2 Children in a Canoe they are going down to the Green Lake to winter, he says that it will be 4 nights more before he reaches there - he says that he is come from the Red Deers Lake & has slept 8 nights - he drew a map in the Indian manner - by my wish - & marked down the different rivers & Creeks that fall into this river all the way to Red Deers Lake - & marked the number of nights & the places he thought we should sleep at - making them 11 nights & that we should arrive at the Cold Lake this Day - we found out afterwards that he had been desired by his Master Mr Shaw to give us every discouraging account he could in order to induce us to return back & that he might have the whole Trade from the Bungees & Towaas - he gave us 1 Swan & 1 Goose - for which & for his seeming kindness & particularity in making & explaining his rough sketch I gave him 1 Quart of Brandy & a little Sugar - when we parted each taking his own road - The Truth or rather falsehood of his map & directions will be found in the following pages - a small Creek & pretty large Lake that this creek runs out off on the North side about 4 miles within - 3 miles making S 2 - 3  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making SW 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  -

*Mr 2 1/2 - L. hat. 3. 22 75. 4. 15*  
*L. P. 54. 14. 38*      *75. 4. 15*

Then 7 miles making W  $\frac{1}{2}$  N 5 and went on hunting on the South side as Buffalo had lately crossed the river - went 4 miles within but saw no animals of any kind - fine open land - with small hammocks of Asp - This hunting excursion should have come in the 1<sup>st</sup> a little after we was away upwards of 2 hours - 3 miles making SW 2 - Then 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making S 1 - SSW 1 - W 1 & put up at 5  $\frac{1}{2}$  PM - woods close along both sides of the river - Good large Pine & c ~ Very few Buffalo Tracks to be seen this day - Killed 12 Geese - Snow laying on the Ground.

**18<sup>th</sup> Wednesday** ~ at 5  $\frac{3}{4}$  am got underway went 6 miles making WbN 4 a small creek on the South Side - 2 miles making NW 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - WbN 1 a long narrow willow Island in the middle of the river - WbS 1 - WNW  $\frac{3}{4}$  - 4  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making NNW 3 - 3 miles making WbS 2 & put up at 4 PM at the Cold Lake House, up a very steep high bank Deserted a few Years since - now all in ruins within - all the out walls still standing - Fresh Gales at NW - dark cloudy very cold weather with flying Showers of Snow - The Ice freezing to the Poles all day

**Sept 18<sup>th</sup>** Saw a many Buffalo Tracks & went on hunting on the South side as Yesterday is mentioned - The river is now betwixt high woods on each side - & the Geese &c is much more scarce than lower down This day only Killed 3 Geese - The Cold Lake within is about 3 miles from the House & river here, about 15 or 20 Miles Long - & 8 or 10 wide - Tho I have never seen it - This is from Indian accounts - an excellent Lake for good Tickameg - which the Canadians generally eat while they remained at this House - to save expenses as the Buffalo tho' pretty plentiful is still more expensive - This House has been established soon after or about the time of the Small Pox in 1781.

**19<sup>th</sup> Thursday** at 6 am got underway, went 10 miles making WbN 7 a small Creek on the South side, with burnt woods at its mouth - high bare Knowls on the same side - a fine low level piece of barren ground on the North side - Small scattered Poplars on same side - 2 ½ miles making NW 2 Little wood all along on the North side - & high banks WNW 1 ½ Cold Lake Creek on North side, about 10 Yards wide, little water in it & stoney running from the Cold Lake apparently about SW into the Beaver river or SSW - Burnt woods on both sides the river, & a fine grassy Knowl on the upper side Old Lake creek - & a small willow Island just above the mouth of it in the Beaver river - 6 miles making W 4 ½ - 4 ½ miles making near SW 3 - these two last courses woods down to the waters edge nearly & not so crooked as below - Good pines these last 10 miles - put up at 5 ½ PM Cold cloudy freezing weather all day - Fresh breezes at NW - Eveng Clear & Calm - Went in search of Buffalo in the Middle of the Day but saw none - we were absent 1 ½ hour, saw numbers of Tracks quite new - Killed 8 Geese -

*c. De Nat. a aquitae 87. 50. 45*  
*Lat. 54. 26. 21      87. 50. 45*

**20<sup>th</sup> Friday** Fresh Gales at EbN, Clear weather, morning calm and very sharp - much Ice along shore in the still bays & some of them froze entirely over - Thermometer at Sun rise + 2 - at 5 ½ am got underway went 2 ½ miles making SbW 2 - 3 ½ miles making near SW 2 ½ a willow Island - 2 ½ miles making WSW 2 - two willow Islands - 2 ½ miles making SW 2 two small willow Islands & a small creek on North side - just above it another willow Isd & much drift woods upon it - 4 ½ miles, making S 3 -

**September 20<sup>th</sup>**

*What @ L 72° 29' 15" Lat. 54° 23' 40"*  
*72° 29' 15"*

This last course mostly crooked & steep banks on the North side; 6 miles making SWbS 4 - 3 miles making WSW 2 - a fine low grassy point on the North side - 2 miles making W 1 - 2 miles making WSW 1 - 2 miles making SSW 1 - 2 miles making SW 1 - 2 miles making WNW 1 ½ & put up at 5 ½ PM - Killed 6 Geese - waiting to get shots at the Geese & c retards us very much on our Journey - very often going after them & not getting sufficiently near to shoot - before they are aware of us and fly away - full one third of our Time is lost in this manner - but it is what we cannot help as we have no provisions but what we kill, all the way - & very fortunately for us the Geese are pretty plentiful - it was rather a wild attempt to undertake this Journey without the necessary provisions ~

**21<sup>st</sup> Saturday** at 5 ¾ am got underway went 9 miles making WbS 5 2 miles making WbS 1 - W 1 a long wide reach & shoal sands, all got out of the Canoe in several places to lighten it - a willow Island in the middle a stout creek on the North side & a fine bank & large willow Isd with 1 pine upon it on the South side - near SSW 2 ½ miles making good 2 miles - SSE 1 - near SWbS ¾ - SW 1 a shoal sandy reach & wide - S 1 broad & shoal sandy - SW ¼ narrow - NNE ⅛ a Large river opposite in this Direction - about 60 Yards wide, & very full of sand - comes apparently from the North - pretty good current - left this river on our right hand & proceeded up Beaver river, which is now not more than 20 Yards wide - low grassy & dirty banks - entered it at 1 ¼ PM - went up it with small variation 3 miles making SSW 2 ½ Moose Creek on the left hand side - for the Particulars of which see page 118 High bare Knowls on the N side it - WbS ⅓ & met John Irwin and Magnus Isbister in a small Canoe they were going to Buckingham House to acquaint them there that John Richards who agreed with us this Summer had left them & all the Goods & gone again to the NW Canadian Company - Mr Shaw debauched him to leave us Put up in Company - rec<sup>d</sup> from them 3 Tickameg & 2 lb of Salt. Fresh breezes at E<sup>t</sup> clear weather - Got 4 Small Ducks only - stoped at 3 PM.

**Sept 22<sup>nd</sup> Sunday** at 5  $\frac{3}{4}$  am we proceeded for the Red Deers Lake & John Irwin &c for Buckingham House - Went 2 miles making WSW 1. 2 miles making WSW 1 a small creek on the South side - 2 miles making NNW 1 - 3 miles NW & NWbN making 2 - 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making NWbN 2 a fine ridge of Barren ground on the North side - 2 miles making WNW 1 -  $\frac{3}{4}$  of a mile making W  $\frac{1}{2}$  - W & WNW 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile - making 1 - a Creek on the South side - WNW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - a fine high hill on the North side - S  $\frac{1}{8}$  a small creek on the South side - & a steep high bank with some wood fallen down it - burnt woods a little above.

*Sept. 22<sup>nd</sup> 70° 52' 15"*  
*Sept. 23<sup>rd</sup> 54° 25' 20" 70° 52' 15"*

5 miles making WNW 4 - 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making W 1 two shoal rapids a small Creek - open & burnt woods on the North side near WSW 1 ~ W  $\frac{1}{4}$  a shoal bad rapid, very stoney - 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making WSW 2 easy current as usual & a fine piece of barren ground hill on the North side - 3 miles making S 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  - & put up at 5  $\frac{1}{2}$  PM - Passed several shoal stony rapids this day - river narrow - & low banks & willows &c Light breezes at W foggy weather in the morning - rain last Night -

**23<sup>rd</sup> Monday** at 5  $\frac{1}{2}$  am got underway - went from S to SW 3 miles making 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  - a shoal rapid & burnt woods on the South side and a steep barren Knowl on the North side - WSW & W 2 miles making 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - WNW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - near NNE  $\frac{1}{4}$  - EbS  $\frac{1}{4}$  - 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile making WNW 1 fine high barren ground on the North side & a pretty stout Creek - near SbW 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile making 1 - near SSE 2  $\frac{1}{4}$  making 1  $\frac{3}{4}$  - a shoal strong Fall - near SbW 3 miles making 2 - SSW  $\frac{3}{4}$  a shoal gravelly ripple & a good creek on the South side - SWbW  $\frac{3}{4}$  fine barren ground on the North side and a shoal gravelly ripple - 7 miles making WSW 5 the lower part of this last course the Pines close to the waters edge on both sides of the river pretty fine barren ground on the North side - upper part short turnings with Pine & willows & a spot of barren ground on the North side and Tent poles - 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile making W 1 - WNW  $\frac{1}{2}$  - a shoal bad rapid - a round hill of Poplars at the head of the reach - W  $\frac{1}{2}$  fine barren ground on the North side - near SW  $\frac{3}{4}$  a shoal bad Fall & small willow Island on the South side - near SSW 1 all one continued strong shoal rapid particularly in 5 places put up at 6 PM - easy current betwixt the rapids - Course Yesterday ESE on the left to SE on the right hand, being 8 Points more than all round the Compass - so very crooked -

**Sept 23<sup>rd</sup>** Fresh Gales at W flying Clouds and warm - great plenty of Buffalo Tracks all along the edge of the river this day - but we saw none we only had the pleasure to see one Old Bull this whole Journey & that was upon the South side of the river the same day we left the Cold Lake House but he was started before we saw him - Killed 1 Swan - 3 Geese & 1 Large Duck -

*Donat. Aquila 87. 51. 45*  
*Lat. 54. 25. 51      87. 51. 45*

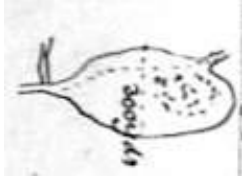
**24<sup>th</sup> Tuesday** Light breezes at W clear fine weather & warm what we did not Cook last night of our Hunt we left as usual near the edge of the Water - in the Night a Jack ash [wolverine] ran away with 2 Geese being all that we have in stock against tomorrow - which is a great loss to us in our present situation - at 5  $\frac{1}{4}$  am got underway - went SSW  $1\frac{3}{4}$  in which are 3 stoney rapids - a fine Island on the South side the river - SW  $\frac{1}{4}$  a steep rapid about 35 Yards long - & at least 4 feet perpendicular very shoal & stoney & strong - SW  $\frac{1}{8}$  Carried the Goods on North side 100 Yards thro a hammock of Pines - a very strong, shoal, steep bad rapid here - WNW  $\frac{1}{4}$  a steep rapid little water upon it led the Canoe on the North side a Pine Island - near W  $\frac{3}{4}$  a shoal stony rapid, & the last we have in this river - Good pines close along the waters edge on both sides with low banks Yesterday & this day - 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles near WbN making 2 - Barren ground in places on the North side & 3 small willow Islands - & came to the entrance of another small river which we go up - & left the Beaver river on our left hand - which apparently takes a Southerly course - a rapid in sight in it - easy current this day betwixt the rapids as usual - & pretty deep - entered the Small river or Creek at 9  $\frac{1}{4}$  am - & went up it 5 miles making WNW 2  $\frac{1}{2}$  two small pine hammocks on the North side & a pretty large creek but no water in it - very crooked from ESE on the left to ESE on the right hand 4 miles making NW  $1\frac{1}{2}$  - pines upon both sides the river - river full of Grass & low grassy swampy sides - Beaver river below from 50 to 100 Yards wide, this only from 5 to 10 - woods about 300 Yards apart & good pine all along mostly on the South side - & barren ground in several places on the North side - a great number of Large pine Trees on S side with their Tops broke off all upon a level - at least 10 or 15 feet off each - this is something singular - Perhaps either Thunder or a strong Whirlwind as been the cause of this singular circumstance a small grass Island & stoney led the Canoe over it - NW  $\frac{1}{4}$  a shoal long rapid, led 100 Yards & carried all 100 Yards more on North side

**Sept 24<sup>th</sup>** a fishing weir lately upon this rapid to catch fish in - I believe this last Spring - WNW 1 a stony ripple, the rest easy current - NWbW 1 easy current & put up at 4  $\frac{1}{3}$  PM - to pitch the Canoe - as she was become leaky by passing over these shoal rapids - low grassy banks as before - river about 12 Yards wide - in some places 20 - We have now killed since we left the Barren Ground Lake to this Day 5 Swans, 59 Geese & 38 Ducks - we have nothing for Supper this night but 1 Swan -

*Swan 87-39-0*  
*Lat 54-32-13*      *87-39-0*

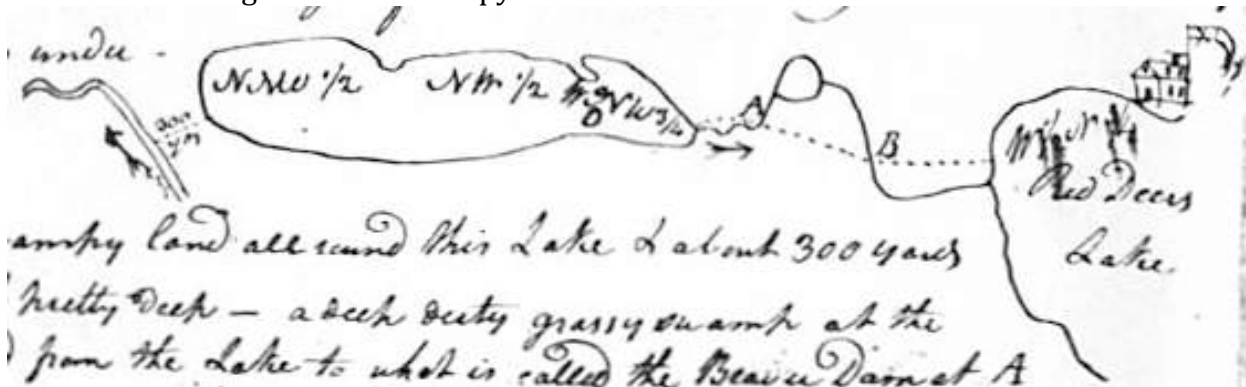
**25<sup>th</sup> Wednesday** Light Airs & variable cloudy weather; a thick fog in the Morning as the river by report is pretty clear of stones above this we embarked at 3  $\frac{1}{2}$  AM & went in the little river as before 5 miles making NWbW 3 - 3 miles making SWbS 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  - 4 miles making WNW 2 & came to 2 Tents of Towau [Ottawa] Indians only 2 Men they have above 2000 lbs of dry provisions made by them this Summer - for themselves & friends, to return to their own Country next Summer at Michelemackinac - we traded from them Furrs & provisions amounting to 42 MBr - to pay them at the Red Deers Lake - where they are soon going - I wished to traded more Provisions from them but they would not - for the above reason - these Inds are very hard to Trade with - obliged to give Scarlet Cloth for the Greater part of what I now received from them, & strong Liquor for the remainder - They also gave us a particular account of the way for this to Red Deers Lake & also drew a just sketch of the Track much more accurately drawn than I have ever seen other Indians do - a small lopped Pine on South side a little above where we found these Indians - This is principally Buffalo meat that they have got - Went 2 miles making NNW  $\frac{3}{4}$  a pretty good Creek on South side which runs from the WSW - 1  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making NNW  $\frac{1}{2}$  good Poplars on the South side - 4  $\frac{1}{2}$  miles making N 3 - led 60 Yards on the South side a long shoal stony rapid - & several small willow Islands - an Image on the South Side made by the Bungees when they first came into these parts - & rigged it well in Cloth & left a variety of other useful necessaries along with it - This is made with an idea that they hope the Great Manneto will grant them & their families health while they remain in these parts & that they may have the agreeable Satisfaction to all be well in health when they pass it on their return to their own country about the Rainy Lake & Grand Portage - 2 miles making NbE 1  $\frac{1}{4}$ ..Led 80 yards - very strong & shoal rapid

**Sept 25<sup>th</sup>** cleared a passage amongst the stones both at this place and the last to get the Canoe over - fine barren ground at the Portage -  $\frac{1}{2}$  mile above this last handing place quite full of large stones all the way with pretty deep water amongst them -  $2\frac{1}{2}$  miles making NNE 1 - all very crooked & grassy as Yesterday - near NNW  $\frac{1}{2}$  a good creek on the South side comes out of a Lake, good current & entered a small Lake as in the Margin -



went thro it NWbN  $\frac{1}{2}$  close along the South shore - much grass & rushes at the upper End of it & went in the river as before, which now becomes much narrower went up it which is very crooked 1 mile & carried all nearly 300 on N side over a very bad portage - & hauled the Canoe up the creek - stony all the way from the Little Lake to the Portage - put up here - remained with the Towau Indians -  $1\frac{1}{2}$  hour - Nin man chee - & Sew we cap po - -

**26<sup>th</sup> Thursday** ~ at 5  $\frac{3}{4}$  am got underway - went  $1\frac{1}{2}$  mile making NW  $\frac{3}{4}$  near  $\frac{1}{2}$  a mile of it very stony - 1 mile making NbW  $\frac{3}{4}$  left this river & carried over a deep grassy Swamp into a Small Lake on the W side 300 Yards - the river contracts much just above the Portage & woods close to the very edge of the water - below an open grassy space betwixt the woods of 2 or 300 Yards wide thro which the little river ran in a very crooked manner it comes out of a pretty large Lake 10 miles farther to the NW - or N - & so very little water & rapidly that there is no going any farther up it in canoes - This is the Height of Land here - went a long the Small swampy Lake as under -



NNW  $\frac{1}{2}$ , NW  $\frac{1}{2}$ , WNW  $\frac{3}{4}$ , B, Red Deers Lake

Low swampy land all round this Lake & about 300 yards wide & pretty deep - a deep dirty grassy swamp at the West end from the Lake to what is called the Beaver Dam at A Left the Dam at 2<sup>#</sup>.12' arrived at the Bridge B at 2<sup>#</sup>.40' & got to the edge of the Red Deers Lake at 3<sup>#</sup>.15' crossing over 3 swamps betwixt the Bridge & the Lake - from the Beaver Dam canoes & goods & every thing is to be carried, little water in the Creek & quite narrow & crooked - left John Ballenden in to take care of the things - found 3 free Canadian Men here who accompanied us to the House from the Beaver Dam - arrived at the House (Greenwich) at 3  $\frac{3}{4}$  & found all our men well there - the foundation of the House not yet laid - To fetch the Canoe & Goods tomorrow - Distance over the carrying place N  $\frac{1}{2}$  E<sup>t</sup> true dist straight 2 miles - along the Track upwards of 4 miles - Light breezes at SE - Clear fine warm weather